SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

25 July 2022 · Shift 1

68 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 32 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Make (something bad or unsatisfactory) better

(A) Judge
(B) Malign
(C) Castigate
(D) Ameliorate

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement reuired’. The “viewing for the” Mount Everest is clearer from here.

(A) view of an
(B) view of
(C) No improvement reuired
(D) viewing of a

Q.3

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. An immense crowd “had gather” to witness this ceremony.

(A) had gathering
(B) gather
(C) No improvement required
(D) had gathered

Q.4

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. When it comes to love of sports, he “takes off” his father.

(A) takes from
(B) takes by
(C) takes after
(D) No improvement required

Q.5

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Bombastic
(B) Arachic
(C) Benign
(D) Artless

Q.6

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer.
Businesses are asking employees to work from home.

(A) employees to work
(B) from home
(C) Businesses are asking
(D) No error

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. A child in an art museum is like “a bull in a China shop.”

(A) A clumsy person in a delicate situation
(B) A person who cries for everything
(C) A talkative person
(D) A person with no moral values

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An afternoon performance in a theatre or cinema

(A) Canvas
(B) Premiere
(C) Comedy
(D) Matinee

Q.9

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An ability to find ways and directions

(A) Navigate
(B) Annotate
(C) drive
(D) operate

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. It was a long and dangerous journey in those unsettled days.The pilgrim had to face _____ by land and sea.

(A) safeties
(B) respite
(C) perils
(D) exposure

Q.11

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Hesitant

(A) Diligent
(B) Remote
(C) Eager
(D) Reluctant

Q.12

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. She didn’t knew / that I was out / for some urgent work.

(A) for some urgent work
(B) No error
(C) that I was out
(D) She didn’t knew

Q.13

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. Many state governments “are facing a” financial crunch.

(A) are facing an
(B) is facing a
(C) will facing a
(D) No improvement required

Q.14

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. I have receive perhaps four / or five such requests during the / course of a typical week.

(A) or five such requests during the
(B) No error
(C) course of a typical week
(D) I have receive perhaps four

Q.15

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Laconic

(A) Verbose
(B) Pithy
(C) Brief
(D) Terse

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Vanquish

(A) Defeat
(B) Acquit
(C) Surrender
(D) Flee

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Overindulgence in anything may prove _____ to health.

(A) spurious
(B) injurious
(C) repetitive
(D) commercial

Q.18

Select the option that rectifies the incorrectly spelt words in the given sentence. The table was grased with a lovelly showpiece.

(A) The table was grased with a lovvely showpiece.
(B) The table was graced with a lovaly showpiece.
(C) The table was graced with a lovely showpiece.
(D) The table was graced with a lovelly showpiece.

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The judges applauded me for my _____ performance at the competition.

(A) usual
(B) normal
(C) outstanding
(D) large

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Bury the hatchet

(A) To change the plans
(B) To make secret preparations to attack
(C) To settle disputes
(D) To hide something controversial

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Love is often thought to be the highest and most fulfilling emotion that men and women can (1)_____. But it is also thought of in (2)_____ to the various instincts in man. Therefore, we must (3)_____ from the mystical point of view that love is the highest emotion of man and the one emotion that relates man to God. Love on every plane and level of life is an expression of God's will, working and expressing itself in man's consciousness. To express love on any level is good, but to express it as adoration of God is the (4)_____ form of love and brings man into the greatest (5)_____ with his inner self.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) condemn
(B) express
(C) attack
(D) condone

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Love is often thought to be the highest and most fulfilling emotion that men and women can (1)_____. But it is also thought of in (2)_____ to the various instincts in man. Therefore, we must (3)_____ from the mystical point of view that love is the highest emotion of man and the one emotion that relates man to God. Love on every plane and level of life is an expression of God's will, working and expressing itself in man's consciousness. To express love on any level is good, but to express it as adoration of God is the (4)_____ form of love and brings man into the greatest (5)_____ with his inner self.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) mention
(B) inspection
(C) position
(D) relation

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Love is often thought to be the highest and most fulfilling emotion that men and women can (1)_____. But it is also thought of in (2)_____ to the various instincts in man. Therefore, we must (3)_____ from the mystical point of view that love is the highest emotion of man and the one emotion that relates man to God. Love on every plane and level of life is an expression of God's will, working and expressing itself in man's consciousness. To express love on any level is good, but to express it as adoration of God is the (4)_____ form of love and brings man into the greatest (5)_____ with his inner self.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) realise
(B) comprehends
(C) acknowledges
(D) contrast

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Love is often thought to be the highest and most fulfilling emotion that men and women can (1)_____. But it is also thought of in (2)_____ to the various instincts in man. Therefore, we must (3)_____ from the mystical point of view that love is the highest emotion of man and the one emotion that relates man to God. Love on every plane and level of life is an expression of God's will, working and expressing itself in man's consciousness. To express love on any level is good, but to express it as adoration of God is the (4)_____ form of love and brings man into the greatest (5)_____ with his inner self.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) smallest
(B) latest
(C) highest
(D) largest

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Love is often thought to be the highest and most fulfilling emotion that men and women can (1)_____. But it is also thought of in (2)_____ to the various instincts in man. Therefore, we must (3)_____ from the mystical point of view that love is the highest emotion of man and the one emotion that relates man to God. Love on every plane and level of life is an expression of God's will, working and expressing itself in man's consciousness. To express love on any level is good, but to express it as adoration of God is the (4)_____ form of love and brings man into the greatest (5)_____ with his inner self.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) suffering
(B) harmony
(C) menace
(D) loathing

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the sixth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and the third number is related to the fourth number. 1246 : 2164 :: 3482 : 4328 :: ? : 2548

(A) 2485
(B) 5284
(C) 2854
(D) 2458

Q.2

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '+' and '×' are interchanged and also '–' and '÷' are interchanged? 4 + 8 ÷ 4 × 2 – 2 = ?

(A) 44
(B) 28
(C) 48
(D) 29

Q.3

What will be the value of the given expression if 'A' means '+', 'B' means '–', 'C' means '×', and 'D' means '÷'? 50 A 40 B 10 C 12 D 2 = ?

(A) 35
(B) 20
(C) 40
(D) 30

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. ROBY : TJDT :: GAIN : ?

(A) IVKI
(B) IUKJ
(C) IUKI
(D) IVKJ

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. LOCAL : SVJHS :: PROOF : WYVVM :: STAGE : ?

(A) ZAHML
(B) ZAINL
(C) ZAHNL
(D) ZAHNK

Q.6

In a certain code language, if Grapes is called Grass, Grass is called Jasmine, Jasmine is called Jaggery, Jaggery is called Melon, and Melon is called Guava, then what is a manmade object?

(A) Jaggery
(B) Melon
(C) Guava
(D) Jasmine

Q.7

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given letter-clusters. AM : EQ

(A) RS : VX
(B) LB : JF
(C) GH : KE
(D) PT : TX

Q.9

8 boys A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H are sitting around a square table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). 4 boys are sitting at each corner, and 4 boys are sitting at the middle of each side of the table. A is an immediate neighbour of H and G. A is sitting at a corner. B is an immediate neighbour of D and C. E is an immediate neighbour of C and F. G is third to the right of D. Three out of the following four options follow a similar rule and form a group. Which of the following does NOT belong to that group?

(A) EB
(B) BH
(C) AF
(D) GC

Q.10

Identify the number that does NOT belong to the following series. 34, 63, 94, 131, 172, 225

(A) 94
(B) 63
(C) 172
(D) 225

Q.11

J, K, L, M and N are sitting on a bench facing towards north (but not necessarily in the same order). J is immediate neighbour of K. L is immediate neighbour of N. J is not sitting with M who sits on the right end of the bench. J sits to the right of L and N. L sits to the right of N. In which position L is sitting?

(A) Second from the right
(B) Second from the left
(C) Fourth from the left
(D) Third from the left

Q.12

Select the option that will replace the question mark (?) in the given series. 49, 53, 61, 73, 89, ?

(A) 108
(B) 109
(C) 107
(D) 111

Q.13

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. YZCD, WXEF, UVGH, STIJ,?

(A) MNKL
(B) QROP
(C) MNOP
(D) QRKL

Q.14

In a certain code language, ‘Parties are scrumptious’ is written as ‘@ # %’, ‘Peter loves parties’ is written as ‘% fr kn’ and ‘Here scrumptious are cakes’ is written as ‘# 6 9 @’. What can be the possible code for ‘Here parties’ in that code language?

(A) # 9
(B) % #
(C) 6 9
(D) % 9

Q.15

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given set. (11, 23, 47)

(A) (17, 35, 69)
(B) (13, 27, 54)
(C) (19, 39, 79)
(D) (23, 46, 93)

Q.17

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All pen are table. All rubber are pen. Conclusions: I. All pen are rubber. II. All table are pen. III. No rubber is table.

(A) Both conclusions II and III follow.
(B) All conclusions follow.
(C) Only conclusion III follows.
(D) Neither conclusion follow.

Q.20

The prices of seven mobiles M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, M6 and M7 are compared. The price of M7 is more than M5 and less than M4. The price of M1 more than M6 and less than M2. The price of M2 is less than the price of M5. If the price of M4 is less than only one mobile, then which of the following options is correct?

(A) M3 > M4
(B) M6 > M5
(C) M1 > M5
(D) M7 > M3

Q.22

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No L is P. II. No R is L. Conclusions: I. Some R are not P. II. Some R are not L.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.23

In a certain code language, 'DETECT' is written as 'FCVCER' and 'HEIGHT' is written as 'JCKEJR'. How will 'MOTHER' be written in that language?

(A) ONVFGP
(B) OMVFGO
(C) OMVEGP
(D) OMVFGP

Q.25

In a certain code language, 'TRUMPS' is written as 'VTWORU' and 'GAYTER' is written as 'ICAVGT'. How will 'HEINAP' be written in that code language?

(A) JGKPCR
(B) JGLPCR
(C) JGLQCR
(D) JGKQCR

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

As per Sample Registration System's 2018 report, what percentage of India's population comes under working age?

(A) 74%
(B) 44%
(C) 85%
(D) 66%

Q.2

The moon moves around the earth in about _____.

(A) 30 days
(B) 24 days
(C) 27 days
(D) 29 days

Q.3

Which lake of India is the result of tectonic activity?

(A) Wular lake
(B) Barapani lake
(C) Dal lake
(D) Loktak lake

Q.4

Jhaveri Sisters are famous for which form of classical dance?

(A) Manipuri
(B) Mohiniyattam
(C) Kuchipudi
(D) Odissi

Q.5

What is the atomic number of sulphur?

(A) 15
(B) 14
(C) 16
(D) 18

Q.6
Article 51 of the Indian Constitution is about _____.

(A) uniform civil code for the citizens
(B) organisation of agriculture and animal husbandry
(C) promotion of international peace and security
(D) separation of judiciary from executive

Q.7
Dhamek stupa is one of the most prominent Buddhist structures in India. It is situated in the _____ district of Uttar Pradesh.

(A) Jaunpur
(B) Agra
(C) Varanasi
(D) Mirzapur

Q.8
Which chapter of the Constitution of India discusses the articles of Parliament?

(A) Chapter III
(B) Chapter I
(C) Chapter II
(D) Chapter IV

Q.9
'Unfinished' is a memoir of the famous Indian actress _____.

(A) Kangana Ranaut
(B) Vidya Balan
(C) Priyanka Chopra Jonas
(D) Sridevi

Q.10
With respect to value addition in the textile industry, knitting is followed by which procedure?

(A) Garment manufacture
(B) Spinning
(C) Fibre production
(D) Dyeing and finishing

Q.11
In which state of India is Nuakhai festival celebrated?

(A) Bihar
(B) Assam
(C) Odisha
(D) Tamil Nadu

Q.12
Which scientist first coined the term, Ecosystem/Ecological System?

(A) Charles Sutherland Elton
(B) Arthur Tansley
(C) Eugene Odum
(D) Frederic Edward Clements

Q.13
According to Article 112 of the Constitution of India, the Union Budget of a year is called _____.

(A) Fiscal Budget
(B) Assessment Statement
(C) Annual Financial Statement
(D) Annual Budget Statement

Q.14
In which of the following events did India NOT win any medal at the Summer Olympics 2020 (played in 2021)?

(A) Men's hockey
(B) Women's singles badminton
(C) Men's javelin throw
(D) Women's hockey

Q.15
Which of the following dynasties ruled over Delhi just after the Sayyid dynasty?

(A) Khalji dynasty
(B) Lodi dynasty
(C) Rajput dynasty
(D) Tughluq dynasty

Q.16
Which Indian state government launched a cleanliness drive called Project CLAP?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.17
Padma Shri awardee, Gaddam Padmaja Reddy was associated with which classical dance of India?

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Manipuri
(C) Sattriya
(D) Kathak

Q.18
The first English factory was set up on the banks of the river Hugli in _____.

(A) 1645
(B) 1651
(C) 1648
(D) 1640

Q.19
Who will be India's Chief G20 Coordinator from May 2022?

(A) Harsh Vardhan Shringla
(B) Rajiv Gauba
(C) Shashi Tharoor
(D) Ajit Doval

Q.20
How many number of players are permitted to be substituted in a game of field hockey?

(A) No limit
(B) 3
(C) 10
(D) 5

Q.22
Which of the following titles was held by Samudragupta, a ruler of the Gupta Dynasty?

(A) Jahan Panah
(B) Sahib-e-Qiran
(C) Kaviraja
(D) Mahendraitya

Q.23
Who was the founder of Brahmo Samaj in 1828, at Calcutta?

(A) Swami Dayanand Saraswati
(B) Ram Singh
(C) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
(D) HN Kunzru

Q.24
What is the capital of India's neighbouring country Afghanistan?

(A) Kandahar
(B) Kathmandu
(C) Kabul
(D) Karachi

Q.25
Pandit Ravi Shankar is associated with _____ musical instrument.

(A) sitar
(B) violin
(C) flute
(D) guitar

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) Ameliorate

To 'ameliorate' is to make something bad or unsatisfactory better. To 'malign' is to speak ill of someone and to 'castigate' to scold severely.

Q.2 · Answer (B) view of

What can be seen from a place is its 'view', which takes 'of', and Mount Everest, a proper name, needs no article: 'The view of Mount Everest is clearer from here.'

Q.3 · Answer (D) had gathered

The past perfect is 'had' with the past participle: 'An immense crowd had gathered to witness this ceremony.'

Q.4 · Answer (C) takes after

To 'take after' a parent is to resemble them: 'he takes after his father'. To 'take off' is to remove something or to leave the ground.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Arachic

'Arachic' is misspelt: the word is 'archaic', meaning very old or old-fashioned.

Q.6 · Answer (D) No error

The sentence is correct: 'ask' takes an object and a to-infinitive ('asking employees to work'), and 'work from home' is the usual phrase.

Q.7 · Answer (A) A clumsy person in a delicate situation

A 'bull in a china shop' is someone clumsy or careless in a place or situation that needs care.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Matinee

A 'matinee' is an afternoon performance in a theatre or cinema. A 'premiere' is the first public performance of a play or film.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Navigate

SSC's key gives 'navigate', to find one's way or plan a route, the only option about finding ways and directions. Strictly the phrase, a noun, describes 'navigation' or a sense of direction, but no option gives that.

Q.10 · Answer (C) perils

'Perils' are serious dangers, which a long and dangerous journey by land and sea brings. A 'respite' is a short rest from something unpleasant.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Reluctant

'Hesitant' means unwilling or slow to act: 'reluctant'. 'Eager' is nearly its opposite.

Q.12 · Answer (D) She didn’t knew

After 'did' (here 'didn't') the verb takes its base form: 'She didn't know that I was out'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) No improvement required

The sentence is correct: the plural subject 'governments' takes 'are', and 'financial' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) I have receive perhaps four

The present perfect is 'have' with the past participle: 'I have received perhaps four or five such requests'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Verbose

'Laconic' means using very few words, so its opposite is 'verbose', using more words than needed. 'Pithy', 'brief' and 'terse' are close to it in meaning.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Defeat

To 'vanquish' is to defeat thoroughly. To 'acquit' is to free someone from a charge.

Q.17 · Answer (B) injurious
'Injurious' means harmful: too much of anything may prove harmful to health. 'Spurious' means false or fake.

Q.18 · Answer (C) The table was graced with a lovely showpiece.
The correct spellings are 'graced' (adorned) and 'lovely', with a single 'l' before the 'y'.

Q.19 · Answer (C) outstanding
Judges applaud an 'outstanding', that is excellent, performance; 'usual', 'normal' and 'large' give no reason for praise.

Q.20 · Answer (C) To settle disputes
To 'bury the hatchet' is to end a quarrel and make peace.

Q.21 · Answer (B) express
Love is an emotion people 'express', that is show; the passage goes on to speak of expressing love on any level.

Q.22 · Answer (D) relation
'In relation to' means with reference to: love is also thought of with reference to man's instincts.

Q.23 · Answer (A) realise
After 'must' the verb takes its base form, which rules out 'comprehends' and 'acknowledges': 'we must realise', that is understand, that love is the highest emotion.

Q.24 · Answer (C) highest
Love expressed as adoration of God is the 'highest' form of love, echoing 'the highest emotion of man' earlier in the passage.

Q.25 · Answer (B) harmony
Such love brings man into the greatest 'harmony', or agreement, with his inner self; the other options are all negative.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (B) 5284
The first two digits swap and so do the last two: 1246 → 2164 and 3482 → 4328. Swapping back, 2548 comes from 5284.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 29
After interchanging the signs: 4 × 8 – 4 + 2 ÷ 2 = 32 – 4 + 1 = 29.

Q.3 · Answer (D) 30
50 + 40 – 10 × 12 ÷ 2 = 50 + 40 – 60 = 30.

Q.4 · Answer (A) IVKI
The letters move +2, –5, +2, –5: R → T, O → J, B → D, Y → T. So G → I, A → V (wrapping round after A), I → K and N → I: IVKI.

Q.5 · Answer (C) ZAHNL
Each letter moves 7 places forward: LOCAL → SVJHS and PROOF → WYVVM. So STAGE → ZAHNL, wrapping round after Z for T → A.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Melon
Jaggery is the man-made object here, and in this code 'Jaggery' is called 'Melon'.

Q.7 · Answer (D) PT : TX
Each letter moves 4 places forward: A → E and M → Q. Likewise P → T and T → X.

Q.9 · Answer (D) GC

The chains D, B, C, E, F and H, A, G close into a circle, and G third to the right of D fixes it: going round to the right, D, H, A, G, F, E, C, B. In EB, BH and AF the second sits second to the right of the first, but C sits third to the right of G.

Q.10 · Answer (D) 225

The differences are consecutive primes: 29, 31, 37, 41 and then 43, so the last term should be 172 + 43 = 215, not 225.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Second from the left

M takes the right end. J sits to the right of both L and N, so at least third, but not fourth, beside M: J is third, N and L take the first two seats in that order and K, J's neighbour, the fourth. L is second from the left.

Q.12 · Answer (B) 109

The differences rise by 4: 4, 8, 12, 16, 20. So 89 + 20 = 109.

Q.13 · Answer (D) QRKL

The first two letters of each cluster move 2 places back (YZ, WX, UV, ST, QR) and the last two 2 places forward (CD, EF, GH, IJ, KL): QRKL.

Q.14 · Answer (D) % 9

'Parties' is in the first two sentences and % in both codes, so 'parties' is %. 'Are' and 'scrumptious' take @ and #, so 'here' and 'cakes' are 6 and 9 in some order, and 'Here parties' can be '% 9'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) (19, 39, 79)

Each number is twice the one before plus 1: 11 × 2 + 1 = 23 and 23 × 2 + 1 = 47. Likewise 19 × 2 + 1 = 39 and 39 × 2 + 1 = 79.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Neither conclusion follow.

All rubber are pen and all pen are table, so all rubber are table: III is false. Neither 'All pen are rubber' nor 'All table are pen' can be drawn from the statements, so no conclusion follows.

Q.20 · Answer (A) M3 > M4

Putting the statements together: M6 < M1 < M2 < M5 < M7 < M4. M4 is cheaper than only one mobile, which must be M3, so M3 > M4.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows

'No R is L' means that R are not L, so II follows. Both R and P lie outside L, but nothing links R to P, so I does not follow.

Q.23 · Answer (D) OMVFGP

The letters move +2 and −2 in turn: DETECT → FCVCER and HEIGHT → JCKEJR. So MOTHER → OMVFGP.

Q.25 · Answer (A) JGKPCR

Each letter moves 2 places forward: TRUMPS → VTWORU and GAYTER → ICAVGT (Y → A). So HEINAP → JGKPCR.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) 66%

The Sample Registration System's Statistical Report 2018 puts 66% of India's population in the working-age group of 15 to 59 years, about two people in every three; roughly a quarter (25.9%) are under 15.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 27 days

The Moon goes once round the Earth in about 27 days (27.3, measured against the stars). The 29.5 days from one new moon to the next is longer because the Earth has meanwhile moved along its own orbit.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Wular lake

Wular lake in Jammu and Kashmir, India's largest freshwater lake, was formed by tectonic activity. Dal is also in Kashmir, Loktak in Manipur and Barapani (Umiam) in Meghalaya.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Manipuri
The Jhaveri Sisters of Mumbai (Nayana, Ranjana, Suverna and Darshana) did much to spread Manipuri dance beyond Manipur.

Q.5 · Answer (C) 16
A sulphur atom has 16 protons, so its atomic number is 16. Phosphorus is 15, silicon 14 and argon 18.

Q.6 · Answer (C) promotion of international peace and security
Article 51, a Directive Principle, asks the State to promote international peace and security. A uniform civil code is Article 44, agriculture and animal husbandry Article 48, and separating the judiciary from the executive Article 50.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Varanasi
The Dhamek stupa stands at Sarnath, near Varanasi, where the Buddha gave his first sermon.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Chapter II
Part V (The Union) of the Constitution deals with Parliament in Chapter II, Articles 79 to 122; Chapter I covers the Executive.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Priyanka Chopra Jonas
'Unfinished', published in 2021, is the memoir of Priyanka Chopra Jonas.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Dyeing and finishing
In the textile value chain the steps are fibre production, spinning, weaving or knitting, dyeing and finishing, and garment manufacture, so dyeing and finishing come after knitting.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Odisha
Nuakhai is the harvest festival of western Odisha, at which the new rice is first offered to the deity and then eaten.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Arthur Tansley
The British ecologist Arthur Tansley introduced the term 'ecosystem' in 1935.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Annual Financial Statement
Article 112 requires the President to lay before Parliament a statement of the government's estimated receipts and spending for each year, called the 'annual financial statement'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Women’s hockey
At the Tokyo 2020 Olympics (held in 2021) the men's hockey team and P V Sindhu won bronze and Neeraj Chopra won the javelin gold, while the women's hockey team lost the bronze medal match to Great Britain and finished fourth.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Lodi dynasty
Bahlul Lodi took the throne of Delhi from the last Sayyid ruler in 1451, founding the Lodi dynasty. The Khaljis and the Tughluqs ruled before the Sayyids.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Andhra Pradesh
Andhra Pradesh launched Clean Andhra Pradesh (CLAP), 'Jagananna Swachha Sankalpam', on 2 October 2021, for door-to-door garbage collection and sorting of waste at source.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Kuchipudi
Gaddam Padmaja Reddy of Hyderabad is a Kuchipudi dancer and guru; she received the Padma Shri in 2022.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 1651
In 1651 the English East India Company set up its first factory on the banks of the Hugli, in Bengal; it already had factories elsewhere in India, such as Surat and Masulipatnam, and its trade in Bengal grew from the Hugli.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Harsh Vardhan Shringla
Harsh Vardhan Shringla, who retired as Foreign Secretary at the end of April 2022, was named Chief Coordinator for India's G20 Presidency and took charge on 1 May 2022.

Q.20 · Answer (A) No limit
Field hockey allows rolling substitutions: the rules put no limit on how many players may be substituted at the same time or on how often a player may go off and come back on.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Kaviraja
The Allahabad pillar inscription praises Samudragupta as 'Kaviraja', king among poets, for his poetry. Mahendraditya was a title of Kumaragupta I.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Raja Ram Mohan Roy
Raja Ram Mohan Roy founded the Brahmo Sabha, later the Brahmo Samaj, in Calcutta in 1828. Swami Dayanand Saraswati founded the Arya Samaj.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Kabul
Kabul is the capital of Afghanistan. Kandahar is another Afghan city, Kathmandu the capital of Nepal and Karachi a city of Pakistan.

Q.25 · Answer (A) sitar
Pandit Ravi Shankar was a sitar player of the Maihar gharana who brought Hindustani classical music to audiences around the world.

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